

Don'ts in Breast feeding

- Avoid prelacteal feeds
- Avoid bottle feed
- Do not discard colostrum
- Do not give water

Checking adequacy of breast feeding

The following indicates that baby is getting adequate breast milk.

- Baby is passing urine 6-7 times a day
- Baby is passing well formed stools
- Sleeping comfortably after feed for atleast 2-3 hours
- Gaining weight adequately.

8.5 Growth and Development

Growth refers to an increase in size and development refers to maturation of function. Starting from conception, growth and development is influenced by various factors both inside the uterus and external environment. Growth and development begin at conception and end at maturity.

Definition of growth and development

Growth is defined as an increase in size of an individual. This increase in size is due to increase in the number and diameter of the cells.

Development denotes the functional maturity of the child. It is the mental maturation with acquisition of skills.

Though growth and development are not the same, they are assessed simultaneously. They are unique characteristics of children and any problem in this process at any stage can result in deviation of growth and /or development.

Stages of Growth

The following are the stages of growth in children

S.N.	Stages	Growth period
1	Embryo	Implantation to 8 weeks of gestation
2	Fetus	9th week of gestation to birth
3	Newborn	Birth to 28 days of life
4	Infant	Birth to 1 year of age
5	Toddler	1-3 years of age
6	Preschool	3-5 years of age
7	School age	6-12 years of age
8	Adolescence	13-18 years of age

Assessment of growth

- Physical anthropometry (weight, height, circumferences of head, chest, abdomen and pelvis)
- Assessment of tissue growth (skin fold thickness and measurement of muscle mass)
- Bone age (x ray of the bone)
- Dental age (by counting the number of erupted teeth)
- Biochemical and histological means.

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